

ProjectDesignPhase

Proposed Solution

Date	3July2026
Project Name	Smart Library Request Workflow using ServiceNow

Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a **Smart Library Request Workflow** developed on the **ServiceNow platform** to digitize and streamline library operations. The system replaces manual book request handling, paper-based approvals, and spreadsheet-driven inventory management with an automated workflow.

solutionbegins whena student submits a borrow request throughthe **ServiceCatalog**.The submitted request is stored in a **custom Bookand Borrow Request table**, where request details suchas Student ID,Student Name, Book ID,BookTitle,RequestDate,andStatus are maintained.

Using **Flow Designer**, the system automatically routes the request to **Librarians for Approval**. Once approved, the workflow automatically updates the **book status from Available to Issued**. When the book is returned, the status is automatically changed back toAvailable. Librarians can also reject requestswithcomments ifthe book is unavailable orthe requestdoes notmeetcriteria.

The solution incorporates **Email Notifications** to keep students informed about request status (approved, rejected, due date reminders), **Role-Based Access Controls (ACLs)** to ensure students can only access their own requests while librarians have full management capabilities, and **Reports and Dashboards** that provide librarians and managerswithreal-timevisibilityintorequestqueues,approvalrates,mostborrowedbooks,andutilizationtrends.

Overall, the proposed solution improves operational efficiency, reduces manual effort, enhances transparency, ensures accurate inventory tracking, and provides a better borrowing experience for students and a more efficient workflow forlibrarians.

S.No.	Parameter	Description
1	ProblemStatement	Academiclibrariesmanagebookrequestsmanuallythrough email,phone,andpaperforms.Thisleadstodelays,lost requests,inaccuratebooktracking,poorvisibilityofbook availability,andincreasedadministrativeeffortforlibrarians. Studentslackclarityonrequeststatusandexpected turnaroundtimes.

2	Idea/Solution Description	Develop a Smart Library Request Workflow using ServiceNow. The solution uses Service Catalog for request submission, custom Book and Borrow Request tables for data storage, Flow Designer for approval and automated status updates, Email
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Solution Summary

		Notifications for request tracking, Role-Based Access Controls for security, and Reports & Dashboards for operational visibility.
3	Novelty/Uniqueness	The solution integrates the complete library borrowing process into a single automated workflow. It combines Service Catalog, custom tables, Flow Designer, automated approvals, real-time book status updates, email notifications, role-based security, dashboards, and reporting—eliminating manual intervention and improving process transparency.
4	Social Impact/ Customer Satisfaction	The solution improves library resource access for students by enabling self-service requests with real-time status visibility. It reduces waiting times, increases request transparency, reduces librarian administrative burden, and provides data insights for better resource planning. Both students and librarians experience faster, more efficient, and more transparent processes.
5	Business Model (Revenue Model)	The solution can be deployed as a library automation service for educational institutions using ServiceNow. Schools, colleges, and universities can adopt it to reduce operational costs, improve library efficiency, enhance student satisfaction, and gain insights into borrowing patterns for better resource allocation and budgeting.
6	Scalability of the Solution	The solution is highly scalable and can support libraries of different sizes. Additional features such as book reservations, barcode/RFID integration, e-books and digital resources, fine management for overdue returns, book renewal functionality, multi-library support, and mobile application access can be added without major architectural changes.